



Home entertainment evolution

The home entertainment industry got an unexpected shot in the arm because of the pandemic. <https://digit.in/agu20-31>



Vernacular audio boom

There are audio based apps that are the desi alternatives to podcasts, and are popular in local languages. <https://digit.in/agu20-32>

Home-grown, high-end sound

Everything you need to know about Kaldas Research's RR1 Conquest, India's very first high-end electrostatic headphone

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ade in India audio products are a rare find. Sure, there are a few audio brands that are based in India,

however, more often than not, the headphones are merely designed in India but manufactured elsewhere. Or at least, a few parts are sourced from other countries. However, Kaldas Research, a private research and development company based in Mumbai, is changing the game. Not only have they manufactured their own audio device, but it is actually a fully home-grown pair of electrostatic headphones! One of the rarest headphone types of headphones that houses ridiculously thin driver elements and require special amplifiers to run it. The company is the only high-end headphone manufacturer in India and they are designing and building each and every component that goes into the headphone in-house. Dubbed the RR1 Conquest, these electrostatic beauties are a testament to the fact that competent audio solutions don't just need to originate from countries such as Germany, Japan, France, and others.



INTRODUCTION TO THE RR1 CONQUEST AND KALDAS RESEARCH

Surprisingly, Kaldas Research is not an audio-focused manufacturing company. It is a private R&D and contract manufacturing company. The RR1 Conquest is Kaldas Research's first venture into the consumer-product space. We spoke to Aumkar Chandan, the CEO and R&D Director at Kaldas Research and he divulged that the company was actually named after his late grandfather, Mr Gokaldas Chan-

dan, who sparked the manufacturing spirit into his family. "With Kaldas, our philosophy is quite simple, we won't sell anything under this brand which isn't in-house."

The RR1 Conquest is a fully in-house developed, high-end electrostatic headphone. The technology is a rather rare mode of transmission in headphones and was popularised by brands such as STAX from Japan and QUAD from the UK. Chandan stated, "Electrostatic transmission has a few inherent advantages such as low inertia, 50/50 pistonic distribution and incorporation of ultra-thin films which gives the technology an edge when it comes to transient response and overall minimised chamber resonances".

Each RR1 Conquest is serialised and comes with individual Measurement Certificates derived from G.R.A.S. and Audio Precision Instruments including metrics such as Frequency Response, %THD, 30/200Hz Square Wave, and Impulse Response. Chandan divulged more about his experience working with G.R.A.S. and Audio Precision



Aumkar Chandan, CEO and R&D Director, Kaldas Research with the RR1 Conquest headphones